BRAND GUIDELINES

2026 EDITION

ShellNest

PREMIUM SOUTH AFRICAN EXPORTS

Prepared by Aleph Creative-Hub

Confidential

BRAND FOUNDATION

Rooted in South Africa. Reaching the World.

ShellNest is a premium South African agricultural enterprise, founded on the principle that the finest natural produce deserves to be shared with the world. Our name evokes both the protective shell of the macadamia and the nurturing nest of growth — a brand born from South African soil, cultivated with care, and exported with pride.

From the sun-drenched rooibos fields of the Western Cape to the lush sugarcane plantations of KwaZulu-Natal, ShellNest represents the full spectrum of South Africa's agricultural excellence. Our portfolio spans heritage teas, premium nuts, and sustainable sugarcane farming.

Every product carries the warmth of South African craftsmanship and the rigour of international quality standards. We bridge the gap between local cultivation and global distribution.

> *"From South African soil to global shelves — premium quality, rooted in heritage."*

Our brand identity reflects the meeting point of tradition and ambition: the deep forest greens of our agricultural landscape, the golden amber of harvest, and the rich earth tones that speak to our origins.

ShellNest Exports

Premium agricultural exports including rooibos tea, honeybush tea, and macadamia nuts. Sourcing directly from South African farmers for international markets.

ShellNest Sugarcane

Sustainable sugarcane farming operations in KwaZulu-Natal, producing raw sugar, molasses, and bio-ethanol feedstock for domestic and export markets.

PRIMARY MARK

The Protea Shield

The primary ShellNest mark is inspired by the King Protea — South Africa's national flower. The stylised shield form conveys protection, premium quality, and deep-rooted heritage. The golden petals rising from the green base symbolise growth, harvest, and the golden produce we export.

LIGHT BACKGROUND

DARK BACKGROUND

TEXTURED SURFACE

GOLD ACCENT

Clear Space & Minimum Size

- Minimum clear space equals the height of one petal (X)
- No text, graphics, or borders within the clear zone
- Minimum reproduction size: 18mm (print) / 60px (digital)
- Always use provided asset files — never recreate
- Do not rotate, distort, or apply effects to the mark

DUAL BRAND ARCHITECTURE

One Brand, Two Divisions

ShellNest Exports

PRIMARY MARK

The Protea Shield serves as the master brand mark and the primary identifier for ShellNest Exports. Used across all corporate communications, packaging, and marketing materials.

ShellNest Sugarcane

DIVISION MARK

The Nautilus Nest represents the sugarcane farming division. The spiral form evokes natural growth patterns, with golden seed elements nestled within the protective green shell structure.

CO-BRANDED

Corporate presentations, investor materials, annual reports

EXPORTS ONLY

Product packaging, export documentation, trade shows

SUGARCANE ONLY

Farming operations, agricultural publications, local materials

BRAND COLOURS

The ShellNest Palette

Our colour system draws directly from the South African landscape: the deep greens of indigenous forests, the golden amber of harvest, and the rich earth of the terrain. Each colour carries intentional meaning and must be used consistently.

PRIMARY COLOURS

Forest Green
#1B4332
C:80 M:30 Y:70 K:50

Golden Amber
#C68B2C
C:10 M:40 Y:85 K:5

Rich Earth
#5C3D2E
C:35 M:55 Y:65 K:45

SECONDARY COLOURS

Leaf Green
#2D6A4F
C:75 M:20 Y:60 K:20

Harvest Gold
#D4A843
C:8 M:30 Y:75 K:0

Cream
#F5F0E8
C:3 M:3 Y:7 K:0

APPLICATION RATIO

60% | 30% | 10%

60% Forest Green — Dominant brand colour. Backgrounds, headers, primary surfaces.
30% Golden Amber — Secondary colour. Accents, highlights, call-to-action elements.
10% Rich Earth — Tertiary. Body text on light backgrounds, subtle accents.

CONTRAST STANDARDS

DARK BACKGROUNDS

Cream (#F5F0E8) for body text. Gold (#C68B2C) for accents and headings. Minimum contrast ratio 4.5:1.

LIGHT BACKGROUNDS

Forest Green (#1B4332) for headings. Rich Earth (#5C3D2E) for body text. Never lighter than #555.

TYPE SYSTEM

Typography Standards

DISPLAY FONT — DM SERIF DISPLAY

ShellNest Exports

Premium South African

Agricultural Excellence

Used for: Headlines, brand name, section titles, pull quotes, hero text. The warm serifs evoke heritage and craftsmanship while maintaining a modern elegance.

BODY FONT — SOURCE SANS 3

LIGHT 300	The finest rooibos, honeybush, and macadamia from South Africa.
REGULAR 400	The finest rooibos, honeybush, and macadamia from South Africa.
SEMIBOLD 600	**The finest rooibos, honeybush, and macadamia from South Africa.**
BOLD 700	**The finest rooibos, honeybush, and macadamia from South Africa.**

Used for: Body copy, navigation, labels, captions, data, and all supporting text. Clean geometric forms ensure readability at any size.

HIERARCHY

Do: Use DM Serif Display for headlines and Source Sans 3 for body. Maintain clear size contrast between levels.

WEIGHT PAIRING

Do: Pair DM Serif Display 400 with Source Sans 3 Light (300) or Regular (400) for elegant contrast.

SPACING

Do: Use letter-spacing of 3-5px for uppercase labels. Use tight tracking for large display text.

SUBSTITUTIONS

Don't: Never substitute with Inter, Roboto, Arial, or Poppins. Fallback: Georgia (display), Helvetica Neue (body).

IMAGE DIRECTION

Photography Standards

Photography Direction

PRODUCT PHOTOGRAPHY

- Overhead flat-lay compositions preferred
- Natural surfaces: dark wood, marble, linen
- Warm, golden lighting with soft shadows
- Shallow depth of field for intimacy
- Raw materials in natural state

LANDSCAPE / FARM

- Golden hour or dramatic dawn lighting
- Aerial perspectives for sugarcane fields
- Rich green and amber colour palette
- Cinematic wide compositions
- Human elements show scale and care

WARM HARVEST
Product shots, export materials, premium positioning

DEEP GREEN
Farm operations, sugarcane division, sustainability messaging

RICH EARTH
Heritage storytelling, origin narratives, artisanal contexts

ShellNest

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